Portfolio Authentication Fix & Update Guide

This repository contains the source code for my personal portfolio website. This documentation details how a Git authentication issue was resolved using a GitHub **Personal Access Token (PAT)**, allowing changes to be safely committed and deployed.

🛠️ Problem Overview

When attempting to edit and push changes to the portfolio repository (e.g., updating content, styling, or asset paths), Git failed to authenticate over HTTPS with the following error:

```
fatal: Authentication failed for
'https://github.com/your-username/portfolio.git/'
```

Cause

GitHub no longer accepts standard account passwords for authenticating Git operations over HTTPS. Any cached or direct password inputs result in permission errors and prevent local edits from being pushed to the remote repository and deployed via GitHub Pages.

💡 Solution: Using a Personal Access Token (PAT)

To resolve the issue, a GitHub Personal Access Token (PAT) was generated and configured locally to re-establish secure access.

Step 1: Generating the PAT

1. Navigated to **GitHub Settings** > **Developer Settings** > **Personal Access Tokens**.
2. Generated a new token with repository access scopes (repo).
3. Copied the newly generated token key.

Step 2: Clearing Stale Credentials

Old cached credentials were cleared from the local environment to prevent persistent authentication failures:

- **Windows Credential Manager:** Removed all entries under git:https://github.com.
- **Git Configuration Reset (Terminal):**

```
git config --global --unset credential.helper
git config --global credential.helper store
```

Step 3: Pushing Portfolio Changes

With the environment cleared and the token generated, the portfolio edits were committed and pushed:

```
# Stage portfolio changes
git add .

# Commit changes
git commit -m "Update portfolio content and styling"

# Push to GitHub
git push origin main
```

When prompted:

- **Username:** <Your GitHub Username>
- **Password:** <Your Copied Personal Access Token>

🚀 Deployment Verification

Once authenticated via PAT, the push completed successfully.

- **Repository Updated:** All local portfolio file changes were merged into the remote repository.
- **GitHub Pages:** Automated deployment rebuilt the website cleanly without further authentication blocks.

🔒 Security Best Practices

To maintain security when working with Personal Access Tokens:

- **Never commit PATs directly to source files or documentation.**
- Set an expiration date for tokens (e.g., 30–90 days).
- Grant only the minimum required permissions (scopes) necessary for the repository.